

Newsletter Audit

Marketing emails, 1 Oct 2025 – 30 Sep 2026 · Source: HubSpot (read-only) · 8 Oct 2026

3/10

HubSpot email health score

HubSpot rating: "Needs work"

3.26%

Click rate

1.03M emails sent

0.81%

Unsubscribe rate

+72% vs previous 12 months

1.29%

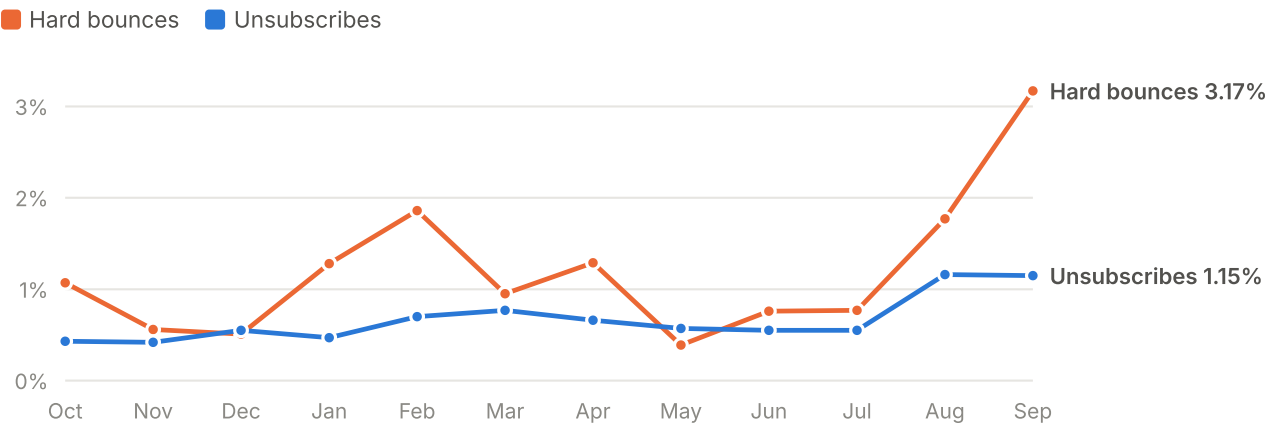
Hard bounce rate

+97% vs previous 12 months

What's flagged

- Hard bounces: 2.54% in the last 30 days. HubSpot's benchmark is 0.25%.
- Unsubscribes: 1.04% in the last 30 days. HubSpot's benchmark is 0.35%.
- 3 sends in Aug–Sep (Japan Sansan list, Corporate Survey 3rd batch, Alibaba startup email) caused 52% of unsubscribes and 79% of bounces in that period.
- Contact limit: 590,458 marketing contacts, which is 93.7% of the 630,000 tier. 433,657 of them have never opened a marketing email. → Appendix 1
- Unsubscribe reasons: no data, because the unsubscribe feedback survey is switched off. → Appendix 3
- Reporting by location isn't possible: none of the 1,042 emails has a team assigned. → Appendix 3
- Old automations: 65 email workflows are still ON but haven't been updated since before 2024. → Appendix 3

Hard bounces and unsubscribes by month (% of delivered emails)



● What's working

Japan newsletter: 9.6% click rate and 0.05% unsubscribes (4 sends, every 2 weeks, its own subscription type).

APAC newsletter: 3.0% click rate, its own subscription type.

Small, targeted emails get high clicks: SV building events, Finland (THF) program emails, mentor and finalist emails.

Spam reports are very low (0.01%) and **98.3% of emails are delivered**.

"Don't send to unengaged contacts" is switched on.

● What can be improved

Large newsletters with low clicks and high unsubscribes: UK, Italy and Fintech & AI Insights (see table).

8 location newsletters share one subscription type ("Marketing Communications"), so contacts can't opt out of just one of them. → [Appendix 2](#)

Few contacts engage: 81,646 of 590,458 marketing contacts opened or clicked an email in the last 12 months. → [Appendix 1](#)

Subscription types need a tidy-up: 14 active and 81 archived.

Main recurring newsletters (Aug-Sep 2026)

Newsletter	Avg. sent to	Click rate	Unsubscribe rate
Fintech & AI Fund Insights	8,611	0.7%	1.42%
Italy Newsletter *	6,624	1.3%	0.96%
UK Newsletter *	6,474	1.1%	0.98%
Global Newsletter (GNL)	5,748	2.4%	0.53%
Texas Newsletter *	4,746	2.9%	0.65%
Startup Autobahn Monthly	4,384	2.1%	0.34%
Central Asia & Caucasus Latest News *	3,302	1.5%	0.76%
APAC Newsletter	2,756	3.0%	0.36%
Seattle Community Newsletter *	1,787	2.2%	0.56%
Indiana Medtech + Lifetech Newsletter *	1,430	1.3%	0.56%
Türkiye Newsletter *	1,420	1.9%	0.56%
Japan Newsletter	989	9.6%	0.05%
Foundation Newsletter	805	0.7%	0.99%
Startup Autobahn Alumni Newsletter	612	0.5%	0.49%
Cyprus Latest News *	309	10.4%	1.94%

Red = above HubSpot's unsubscribe benchmark (0.35%). * = sent under the shared "Marketing Communications" subscription type.

● Possible next steps

- 1 **Imported lists:** check and clean large imported lists before sending, and send a small test batch first.
- 2 **Unsubscribe survey:** switch it on so we can see why people leave (needs a HubSpot admin).
- 3 **Inactive contacts:** review the 433,657 marketing contacts who have never opened an email, and decide with the manager/admin whether to set them as non-marketing.
- 4 **Subscription types:** give the main location newsletters (UK, Italy, Texas...) their own subscription type, like Japan and APAC.
- 5 **Teams and naming:** assign a team and use one naming format on every email so results can be reported by location.
- 6 **Workflows:** review the 65 old workflows with their owners and switch off the ones no longer needed.
- 7 **Newsletter owners:** confirm who owns each newsletter and how often it's sent.
- 8 **Check again in 90 days:** health score, bounces, unsubscribes and marketing contacts.

Newsletter-level figures are based on the latest 100 of 1,042 emails sent (Aug-Sep 2026). All other figures cover the full 12 months. Full data is in *PNP_HubSpot_Newsletter_Audit.xlsx*.

1. Marketing contacts who don't engage

Where the numbers come from, and how to check them yourself in HubSpot. Nothing needs to be saved.

What	Contacts	% of marketing contacts	Where in HubSpot
Marketing contacts (billed)	590,458	100%	Settings > Account & Billing > Usage & limits
Marketing contact tier (limit)	630,000	–	Same page · 93.7% used · next update 31 Oct 2026
No marketing email open or click in last 12 months	508,812	86.2%	Contacts > filters (below)
Never opened a marketing email	433,657	73.4%	Contacts > filters (below)
Opened or clicked in last 12 months	81,646	13.8%	590,458 – 508,812
Clicked in last 12 months (all contacts)	20,539	–	Contacts > filters

How to check it (Contacts > All contacts > Advanced filters, don't save the view)

- 1

Marketing contacts: "Marketing contact status" is Marketing contact → 590,458. This matches the billing page.
- 2

Inactive 12 months: add "Last marketing email open date" is not within last 12 months and "Last marketing email click date" is not within last 12 months → 508,812.
- 3

Never opened: filter 1 + "Last marketing email open date" is unknown → 433,657.

Why it matters: HubSpot bills by the number of *marketing* contacts, in tiers. Contacts set as non-marketing stay in the CRM but don't count toward the tier ([HubSpot: marketing contacts billing](#)). There's room for 39,542 more marketing contacts before the next tier.

Good to know before acting: "never opened" can include recently added contacts and people whose email app blocks open tracking. The billing amount itself wasn't visible to Felipe's user (restricted billing access). Counts pulled read-only on 8 Oct 2026.

2. Location newsletters share one subscription type

Subscription type of each location newsletter sent between 6 Aug and 30 Sep 2026 (Marketing > Email > Manage).

Email	Sent	From	Subscription type
UK September 2026 Newsletter	30 Sep	Kieran Borrett	Marketing Communications
UK August 2026 Newsletter	2 Sep	Kieran Borrett	Marketing Communications
TEXAS September Newsletter	29 Sep	Francis from Plug and Play	Marketing Communications
TEXAS August Newsletter	26 Aug	Francis from Plug and Play	Marketing Communications
ITA26_Newsletter September	17 Sep	Tommaso Maschera	Marketing Communications
ITA26_Newsletter August	6 Aug	Tommaso Maschera	Marketing Communications
Seattle Community Newsletter (Aug 2026)	1 Sep	Emmanuel Chan	Marketing Communications
Indiana Medtech + Lifetech Newsletter September 2026	18 Sep	Plug and Play Indiana	Marketing Communications
Plug and Play Türkiye August 2026 Newsletter	31 Aug	Zeynep from Plug and Play	Marketing Communications
Plug and Play Cyprus_Latest News_09/26	4 Sep	Victoria (Cyprus)	Marketing Communications
PNPCA_Latest News_ August_2026	4 Sep	Sofi (Central Asia & Caucasus)	Marketing Communications
JAP_Newsletter (4 sends)	Aug-Sep	Plug and Play Japan	Plug and Play Japan
APAC_Newsletter (2 sends)	Aug-Sep	Plug and Play APAC	Plug and Play APAC

Each location used to have its own type, and those are now archived

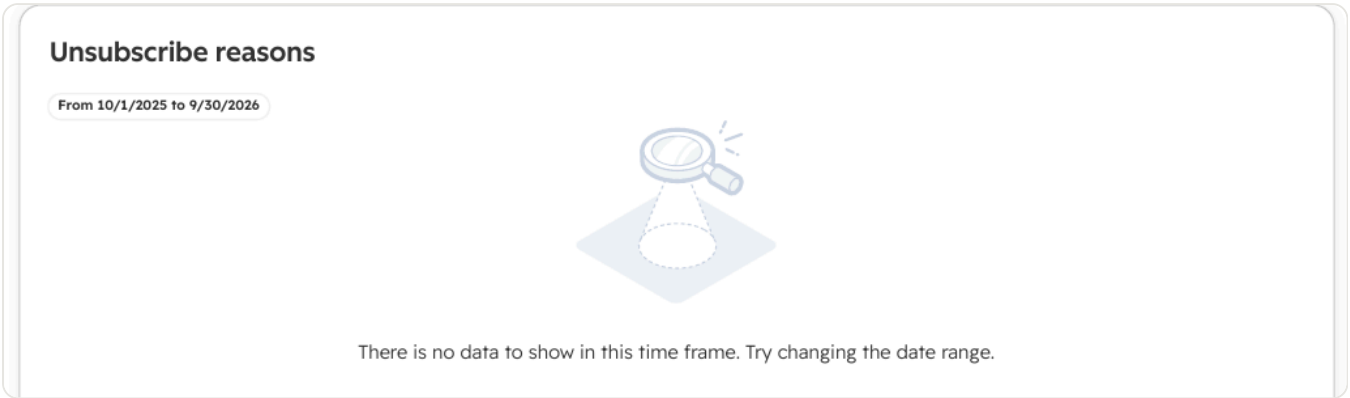
Location	Own subscription type (Settings > Marketing > Email > Subscriptions)	Status
UK	Plug and Play UK Communications	Archived
Texas	Plug and Play Texas	Archived
Italy	Plug and Play Italy (2 types)	Archived
Seattle	Plug and Play Seattle	Archived
Indiana	Plug and Play Indiana	Archived
Türkiye	Plug and Play Istanbul Communications	Archived
Central Asia	Plug and Play Central Asia & Caucasus	Archived
Cyprus	— none exists	—

What this means: if someone unsubscribes from "Marketing Communications" in, say, the UK newsletter, they stop receiving **everything sent under that type**. That's all 8 location newsletters above, plus other emails that use it (32 of the 97 emails sent in Aug-Sep). They still receive other types (e.g. Global Newsletter, Events) unless they choose "unsubscribe from all".

How to check: open any of the emails above in HubSpot and look at its subscription type. In Settings > Marketing > Email > Subscriptions, show archived types.

3. Basic tracking

a) Unsubscribe survey is OFF, so there are no unsubscribe reasons



Screenshot from the HubSpot Analyze export (1 Oct 2025 – 30 Sep 2026), page 2. Setting: Settings > Marketing > Email > Subscriptions > "Unsubscribe feedback survey": OFF.

b) No team assigned to any email

All **1,042** emails sent in the 12 months have no team, even though HubSpot has **62 teams** set up (e.g. Japan 32 users, Marketing 15, APAC 5, London 3). Results can't be filtered by location in HubSpot today. How to check: Marketing > Email > Manage, filter by team; or open an email and look at its team/access setting.

c) Old email workflows still switched ON

Workflows with a "Send email" action		Count
Total		309
ON		251
ON and last updated before 2024 (oldest: Oct 2020)		65
Still ON, COVID-era ebook workflows	Last updated	Enrolled now
JAP_eBook_COVID-19	2024-09-04	0
TVL_Ebook_Rebooting Travel after COVID-19	2023-06-29	0
PNP_World After COVID_Ebook Download	2023-06-29	0
SMC_Ebook_Rethinking Smart Cities after COVID-19	2022-12-27	0
HTH_Ebook_Top Health Startups fighting COVID-19	2021-02-17	0

These send only when someone triggers them (e.g. fills in the old ebook form). None has anyone enrolled right now. How to check: Automation > Workflows, filter Action type = Send email and Status = On, then sort by Last updated. The full list of 65 is in the spreadsheet (tab "Old Workflows").